Archæological Survey of Western India. No. X

INSCRIPTIONS

FROM

THE CAVE-TEMPLES OF WESTERN INDIA,

WITH

DESCRIPTIVE NOTES, &c.

BY

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AND

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PREFATORY NOTE.

THE descriptive notes in this memorandum were prepared in February 1880, and are necessarily fragmentary, as being supplementary to the information in *The Cave Temples of India*, and chiefly intended to preserve additional notes which have either come to hand since that work was sent to the press, or which could not conveniently be wrought into it. In several cases their object is chiefly to indicate distinctly the position of each inscription.

The inscriptions from the various caves have been prepared by Paṇḍit Bhagwânlâl Indraji and myself, as explained in the text. I am indebted, however, to Dr. G. Bühler, C.I.E., for notes and suggestions; to J. F. Fleet, Esq., C.S., for the preparation of the Mârasiṁha grant and the revisal of the proofs of the three inscriptions that follow it; and to Dr. E. W. West for the translations of the Pahlavi inscriptions at Kaṇheri which were supplied to the *Indian Antiquary*, while these notes were passing through the press, and incorporated at p. 63; and also for the use of numerous notes and drawings from which part of the materials used have been drawn. The impressions of the Kuḍâ inscriptions taken by the Archæological Survey in 1877-78, being in England, Dr. West's very excellent copies have been employed in their place.

It is the first time that any large collection of the cave-inscriptions has been made in one paper, and it is only to be regretted that want of time has prevented the completion of them here. The Nâsik, Kaṇheri, and Nânâghâṭ inscriptions yet remain to be translated; but fac-similes have been taken of all except of a portion of those at Kaṇheri, and these, I hope, will be made this season.

From the abraded and fragmentary character of many of these inscriptions, it will be understood that the translations are to a certain extent only tentative. They suggest many points of interest which must be discussed elsewhere: it has been my main object to supply the materials for such discussion. The fac-similes alone ought to be valuable as a contribution to Indian palæography, especially from the later Maurya period about B.C. 200 to the 7th century A.D.

The plates were printed off and a large portion of the following pages were in type before I left Bombay on 1st May last, but only about a third of the matter had been printed off. Since then, owing to my distance from the press and other causes, the printing has been carried to completion more slowly than I had expected.

J. BURGESS,

Archæological Surveyor.

Edinburgh, 20th April 1881.

CONTENTS.

No.		Page.
1.	Notes on the Rock-Temples at Mhâr and Kuḍâ and their Inscriptions ...	1
	Kuḍâ Caves	3
2.	Bhâjâ Caves and their Inscriptions	22
3.	The Inscriptions at Beḍsâ Caves	25
4.	The Inscriptions in the Kârlê Caves	27
5.	S'ailarwâḍi Cave Inscription	38
6.	Bauddha Inscription from Kolhâpur	39
7.	Pitalkhorâ Cave Inscriptions	*ib.*
8.	Junnar Caves and Inscriptions	41
9.	Kaṇheri Caves	56
	„ Copperplate	57
	„ S'ilahâra Inscriptions	60
	„ Pahlavi Inscriptions	62
	„ „ „ No. 1	*ib.*
	„ „ „ No. 2	63
	„ „ „ No. 3	64
	„ Vihâr Coins	66
10.	Cave at Ambivale	*ib.*
11.	Ajaṇṭâ Caves: early Paintings	67
	„ „ Rock Inscriptions	*ib.*
	„ „ Painted Inscriptions	80
12.	Ghaṭotkacha Inscription	88
13.	Elurâ Inscriptions: Viśvakarma Cave	91
	„ „ Dâsa Avatâra	92
	„ „ Kailâsa	96
	„ „ Râmêśvara	98
	„ „ The Jaina Caves	*ib.*
	„ „ Pârśvanâtha	99
14.	Banavâsi Pâli Inscription	100
15.	S'ilahâra Grant of Mârasimha	101
16.	Three Inscriptions in possession of the American Oriental Society ...	105
17.	Transcription of some Gujarâti Copperplates	112

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1.—NOTES ON THE ROCK-TEMPLES AT MHÂṚ AND KUḌÂ AND THEIR INSCRIPTIONS.

THE small village of Pâl is about a mile north-west from Mhâṛ. Near it is a group of caves excavated in the almost perpendicular scarp of a hill, and numbering about twenty-eight in all. As they have never been described in any detail, the following rough notes may be of use. Beginning from the south end of the series :—

Excavation No. I is the largest in the group. It is unfinished and seems to have been suddenly stopped (see plan, Plate I). A seat 1½ feet high runs round three sides of the main chamber. Floor of cells 3 feet above the hall. Right side of the hall was being extended by cutting away a layer of 8 or 9 inches. E is a raised portion of the verandah floor ; it seems as if the floor was being lowered a foot, and a part at E left unfinished. The shrine contains a rough square mass, as if for a dâgoba. Upon the front of it at D is rudely sculptured a Buddha in bas-relief. On the sides at B and C are standing attendants. This is the only sculpture in any of the caves here. There are six rough columns in the verandah : the left one (A) is finished (see sketch). Most of the other five columns have a bracket left at the top.

In front of Cave I, at a lower level, are three tanks 14 or 15 feet square each. Two have small square entrances, the other is perhaps partly broken in.

Cave II. See plan : inner cell unfinished.

Cave III. The most perfect of the series. At F is the entrance to a well. A stair-case leads not only to No. IV, but still lower to the level of the tanks in front of No. I. Its exit has been ruined, but the steps there are now built up with loose stones. The inner verandah is now chunamed and panelled (see plate). The door into the hall has sockets for posts. An irregular recess at the right end of the verandah contains a seat, beaded, and has pilasters ; seats inside the parapet also beaded ; column of verandah as in the plate.

No. IV. Verandah has two columns—broken. Sockets for posts in the floor and ceiling, just inside the front door. The partition wall is broken through in two places.

No. V. Verandah has two octagonal columns with bases 20 inches square. Square pilasters both ornamented in the style so common at Kaṇheri and Junnar (see plate). Parapet with seat inside, between pillars and pilasters. Front of verandah is smoothly polished and still very perfect. The hall is rough and has been plastered with clay. A seat runs round three sides 18 inches high, with plain beading. Front door has sockets in the floor and in the top of door jamb for posts. The front of this cave has been almost exactly similar to No. III, and to one or two others in the series.

No. VI. A small unfinished cell, about the same level as the tanks in front of No. I.

No. VII. A larger unfinished cell, having a tank at the left side of the front, half filled with mud.

No. VIII. A larger irregular cave with verandah.

No. IX. Two carved pillars in front are broken away. Capitals are of the Nâsik and Junnar lotâ-shape type. Pilasters ornamented as those in No. V, which also occurs in another cave. The hall has a seat round back and two sides: three cells in the left and as many in the right side: large recess from the hall in the back wall for dâgoba, which has been removed, but the umbrella remains attached to the roof: on each side of this recess is a cell. There are small holes as if for a screen across the front of the recess. All the cell doors have sockets for frames as in No. III. The following inscription of four lines and two letters is on the back of the hall to the right:—

MHAR INSCRIPTION.[1]

Trnsliteration.

सिधं कुमारस काणभोअस व्हेणुपालितस
(ए)स लेण चेतिएघर ओवरका च अठ ८ वि[2]कमं नियु-
तं ले[3][ण]स च उभतो पसेसु पोढियो बे २ लेणस
अलिंगणके[4] पथो च दतो एतस च कुमारस देय
धमं

Sanskrit.

सिद्धम् कुमारस्य काणभोजस्य विष्णुपालितस्यै-
तल्लयनं चैत्यगृहमपवरकाश्चाष्टौ ८ इति कर्म नियु-
क्तं लयनस्य चोभयतः पार्श्वयोः प्रही द्वौ २ लयनस्य
आलम्नकः(?) पन्थाश्च दत्तः एतस्य च कुमारस्य देय-
धर्मः ॥

Translation.

"To the Perfect one! Prince Kâṇabhoa Vheṇupâlita's[5] Leṇa, chaityagṛiha, and eight (8)[6] cells; this much work is endowed, and two (2) cisterns on each side of the Leṇa, also a passage connected[7] with the Leṇa are presented. It is a charitable gift of that Kumâra (*or* Prince)."[8]

[1] Transliterated and translated by Bhagwânlâl Indraji Paṇḍit.

[2] Read ति.

[3] I believe that the writer has by mistake omitted the letter *ṇa* after *le* in this word.

[4] Or ०ल्लु०.

[5] Sans. Kâṇabhoja Vishṇupâlita. The Sanskṛit Vishṇu is changed into Vehṇu in Prâkṛit, whereas we here find Vheṇu in the name Vheṇupâlita. This must either be a mistake or a local style of spelling. From the titles *Kumâra* and *Kâṇabhoa* it seems that Vishṇupâlita must have been of royal family, for it is not customary to affix *Kumâra* to any but princes. Kâṇabhoja must be the name of the family similar to *Mahâbhoja* found in the Kuḍâ inscriptions, and it is highly probable that this family was ruling in Mhâr (where the inscription is found) and the other surrounding minor districts.

[6] After the figure 8, a letter like *vi* is visible, but it seems to be a mistake for *ti*; *ti* in Prâkṛit is used for Sanskṛit *iti*, "this much," "so much."

[7] *Aliganaka* or *aluganaka* might be a corruption of the Sanskṛit *âlagnaka*, "attached," which seems to be a suitable word in the place.

[8] The characters of this record seem to be of about the time of Vâsishṭhîputra the Andhrabhṛitya.

There are ten more caves at this level,—one, a small open cell with a dâgoba 5 or 6 feet high.

In the next level, the seventh contains a short *inscription* at the right end of the verandah, and at the other end of the same verandah is a small dâgoba in relief. One of the preceding six is a cell with a dâgoba, as above.

The most northerly cave next to this last and containing the inscription, is at a much lower level—the lowest in the series.

There are 27 or 28 caves in all, exclusive of tanks. Nos. II and III are the highest. They are in a straight portion of the hill, with an easterly aspect, less than a mile from Mhâṛ. The parapets in front of two of the undescribed caves are carved in the "rail pattern" with thin uprights.[1]

At the foot of the hill, under some trees, are three fallen dâgobas, which must have stood close to where they now lie.

Kôl,—a small village across the Sâvitrî, south-east from Mhâṛ. In a hill behind it are two small groups of caves—the first to the north-east of the village consists of a few dilapidated cells; the other to the south-east contains one cell larger than any of the others, but all are apparently unfinished. In this second group are *three* short inscriptions. One of them reads thus :—

Transcript.[2]

Gahapatiputasa seṭhisa.

agharakhitasa deyadhamaṁ lena(ṁ).

Translation.

"A cave, the religious gift of Śeṭh Sagharakhita (*Saṁgharakshita*), son of Gahapati."

In a hill to the north-east of Mhâṛ are a few cells and cisterns, and there is a cell in a hill to the south, near the road leading to Nâgotanâ.

Kuḍâ is on the east side of the north-east arm of the Râjapur creek. A small branch creek runs up through mangrove bushes nearly to the village. The caves are about 150 to 200 feet above the sea level in a hill which is about 250 feet high at this point. They face to west-south-west, and the whole 26 caves are within about 200 yards in two lines of elevation,—Nos. I to XV below, and Nos. XVI to XXVI some forty feet higher up the hill. The view from the caves is splendid, the wide expanse of the Râjapur creek, like a mountain lake, some 5 miles wide, is right in front, entirely shut in by hills from 200 to 600 feet in height, which in most places run down nearly to the water, and a rocky islet occupies nearly the centre of the seeming lake. From the top of the hill, the hill fort of Ṭhala is plainly visible, and another to the north. The creek is called Kâlwa khâḍî, and the hill north-east of the caves Mohola.

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[1] I have largely availed myself of Mr. A. A. West's very full notes in this account; the plate also is from his drawings. Conf. Dr. Wilson's account, *J. B. B. R. A. S.*, vol. III., pt. ii, p. 43.

[2] Translated by Dr. G. Bühler, C. I. E.

Cave No. I. Debris in front 2 feet higher than the floor of cave; little or no court. Front of the verandah, broken away; has had two plain octagonal columns and square pilasters with ornament—as in Mhâr caves—broken. At the left end is a plain cell with recessed bench or bed towards the back of the cave. Inscription (No. 1)[1] in two lines[2] is over the door of this, and extends along the back as far as the central door (2nd plate). It is deeply cut on a smooth surface and very distinct; the upper line seems complete, but some letters are wanting at the end of the second line, where the wall is broken away.

INSCRIPTION No. 1.

Transcript.

[१] महाभोजीय सडगेरिय विजयाय पुतस महाभोजस मंडवस खंदपालितस लेखकस[3]

[२] सुलसदतपुतस उतरदतापुतस च सिवभूतिस सह भयाय णंदाय देयधंमं [लिणं]

Sanskrit.[4]

महाभोज्या सडगेर्य्या विजयायाः पुत्रस्य महाभोजस्य माण्डपस्य स्कन्दपालितस्य लेखकस्य सुलसदत्तपुत्रस्य उत्तरदत्तापुत्रस्य च शिवभूतेः सह भार्य्यया नन्दया देयधर्मो [लयनम्] ॥

Translation.

"This cave is the meritorious gift of Sivabhûti, the son of Sulasadata and Utaradatâ, and writer to Mahâbhoja Mandava Khandapâlita,[5] son of Mahâbhoja Saḍagerî Vijayâ—together with his wife Namdâ."

Remarks.

Mahâbhoja is a title probably equivalent to *râja*.[6] It occurs also in No. 2 of the Beḍsâ inscriptions, under the form *Mahâbhoya*.

Saḍagerî is apparently connected with the epithet *Sâḍakara*, given to Mahâbhoja Sudaṁsana in inscription 19: it may be a family name or title.

Mandava may be either the Sanskrit *Mâṇḍavya* or *Mâṇḍapa*. In the first case the epithet would characterise Khandapâlita as a member of a Brahmanical *gotra* or race; in the second it might indicate that he was lord of a town called Maṇḍapa. This latter seems the preferable explanation as *Maṇḍapa* is a very common name for towns all over India, and three small villages called Mâḍâḍ or Maṇḍâḍh, *i.e.*, probably *Maṇḍapagaḍh*, lie close to Kuḍâ. Moreover, we have Bhag-Mândala and Kol-Mândala or Mândana near the mouth of the Sâvitrî or Bânkot River, which appear to correspond to the 'Mandabad' of Barbosa (1514); and a little to the south of the same river are Madangaḍh and Mândivali.[7]

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[1] The accompanying plates of inscriptions are from a series of very excellent copies, made many years ago by the Messrs. West and very kindly handed over to me with all their notes and drawings by Dr. E. West and A. A. West, Esq.

[2] Prof. H. Jacobi of Munster has tranliterated and translated this inscription in *India Antiquary*, vol. VII., p. 253.

[3] The *ka* wants the cross stroke in the copy, but the stone is injured here and there can be no doubt that the letter is *ka*.

[4] The translations and remarks are the work of Paṇḍit Bhagwânlâl Indraji: I have rendered them into English.

[5] Sans. Skandapâlita.

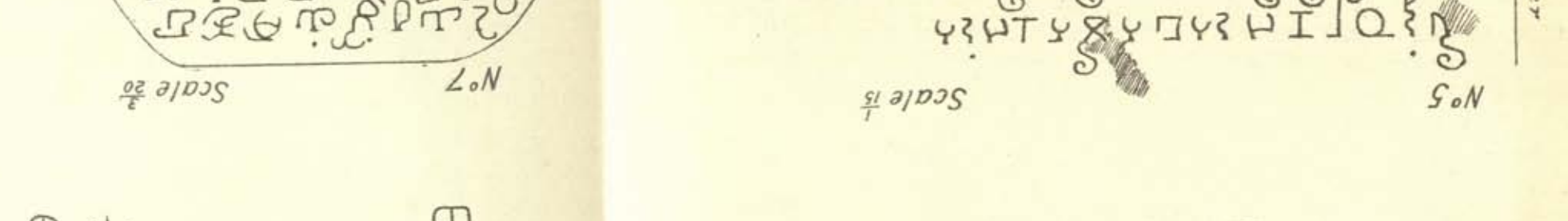
[6] See Prof. Jacobi's remarks, *Ind. Ant.*, vol. VII., p. 254.

[7] The Mandagara of Ptolemy is to be sought for in this neighbourhood.

Kudá Inscriptions

No 1

Scale $\frac{1}{20}$

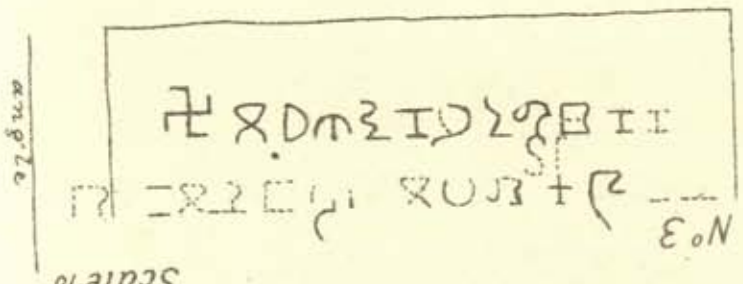


No 2 Scale $\frac{1}{20}$



No 3

Scale $\frac{1}{10}$



Door of cell.

No 4

Scale $\frac{1}{10}$



No 5

Scale $\frac{1}{15}$

No 6

Scale $\frac{3}{20}$

No 7

Scale $\frac{3}{20}$

No 8

Scale $\frac{3}{20}$

Photozincographed. Govt. Office, Poona, 1880.

Leṇam at the end is broken away, but part of the letter *le* is still left.

The doorway in the centre is 7 feet wide, with sockets for door-posts. Plain square hall, leading at the back into an ante-chamber the full width of the hall, with two plain octagonal columns in front on a raised sill, and two square pilasters with the same ornament as the outer ones, but perfect: one of the columns fallen. The antechamber is plain, with remains of plaster on the walls. In the middle of the back is a 9½-feet doorway, without holes for wood-work: a bench runs round the ends and remainder of the back. The shrine is nearly square, with a middle-sized dâgoba in the centre.

No. II adjoins No. I and is on the same level; court very small. The front room or verandah has a door and a large open window; it has a recessed bench at the left end. Behind, towards the right side, is a cell with stone bed in the left side. Both doors have sockets for wooden frames, and there are traces of plaster on the walls of the outer room.

No. III, close adjoining, 1 foot lower level. Court small. On the left-hand side wall outside, is a fragment of an inscription (No. 2), being the ends of two lines deeply cut on a rough surface,—the rest is peeled off:—

INSCRIPTION No. 2.

Pâli.	*Sanskrit.*
.....भूतिस	.....भूतेः
.....लेनं	.....लयनम्॥

The first line ending in *bhûtisa* suggests the name of Sivabhûti, as in the first inscription. In the second *lenaṁ* only is left. The cave was probably the gift of a member of the same family.

No. IV, about 12 feet to the right, and at 10 feet higher level; has a court with a bench on each side; steps up to the verandah, broken. The verandah has two octagonal pillars with square bases, and square pilasters with the same ornament as at Mhâṛ. A thin parapet joins each column with its corresponding pilaster, with rail pattern outside—the uprights carved with the ornament of the pilaster only doubled in the height. At the back of the verandah is a large central door, with a window on each side of it. Hall 1′ 6″ higher than the verandah—plain, square, with bench round back and two sides. Three recesses begun in the back wall with square pillars between them. No plaster in this cave, which was evidently never completed.

No. V close adjoining, and at 6 feet lower level; has a court with a tank of good water in a recess in the left. Inscription No. 3 is above the level of, and to the right hand of, this recess; it has been cut moderately deep on a rough surface, and is much weather-worn—many of the letters are very uncertain.

INSCRIPTION No. 3.

This is too much damaged to be decipherable. In the second line we might read:—

poḍhio be 2 *deya dhamaṁ.*

"The charitable gift of two (2) cisterns."

The 3rd letter resembles *ba*, the next is either *hi* or *dhi*, the lower stroke of the next letter is rather long for *o*, and the following two characters may be also misreadings in the copy.